What to buy

When going in for a hard drive remember the following

1. When you want a lot of space getting a hard disk is the wiser option compared to SSDs.
2. Drives marked as eco-friendly or Green are likely to have poor transfer speeds but are great at saving power, only get these if you have a normal drive(7200 RPM) as your primary disk.
3. When going for a RAID configuration always opt for similar drives with similar capacities from the same manufacturer for best results.
4. Laptop hard drives use the same SATA power connector as desktop drives so they are used by folks who want a cheaper option to portable drives, though if you are a beginner we'd recommend that you stick to the portable drive instead of buying a naked laptop drive.

SSD

The latest entrant in the storage media evolution is the SSD or Solid State Drive. You've read about SSDs and you've read about RAM. One is faster than the other while the other is non-volatile so the logical step was to create a drive that would be faster and non-volatile. Thus, the SSDs were born. Now both RAM chips and Hard drives have been around for quite a long time but it was not feasible till this time owing to the low capacities per chip and the cost per chip. Even now the cost per GB for SSDs is quite high compared to HDDs.

Types of memory chips

NAND flash memory acts as the primary data storage chip for most SSDs. These are available in two variants - SLC (Single Level Cell) and MLC (Multi Level Cell). SLC is faster and has lower density than MLC, so they are expensive. They are usually found in enterprise and enthusiast drives where high transfer rates are necessary. They